



STAT ATTACK

It's all in the numbers

70% of all porn access on the net occurs during office hours

Only **33%** of households actively protect their children from the internet

70% of all security breaches are caused by insiders

63% of parents using SMS services feel this improves communication with their children

In the year 2008, **\$865 Billion** was invested in IT products and services

50% of all returned IT products work, but can't be figured out by buyers

seems identifying culprits isn't so easy. There is the *Catch-22* of fair use and besides, many of the law suits by the RIAA resulted in grandmothers being dragged into court, based on sometimes specious evidence. To many, internet connections are essential lifelines to school, work, and other important parts of daily life that we will not mention. Considering these, many of RIAA's detractors will certainly put up a fight. Oh! by the way, the Motion Picture Association of America is also in discussion with ISPs to adopt the same strategy.

SHARK INFESTED WATERS?

Undersea cables cut again

No it's not the poor lil sharks. At the outset of 2008, a badly dropped ship anchor had damaged an undersea Internet provisioning telecom cable in the Mediterranean, disrupting Internet service throughout India, Sri Lanka, Pakistan, and the Middle East. And this year its *deja-vu* all over again. The lines, which emanate from the Egyptian

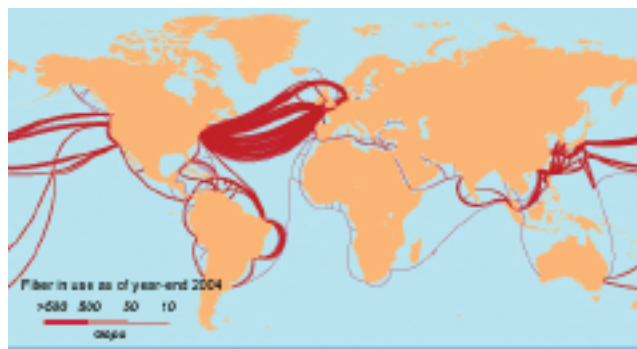
coast at Alexandria and go on to connect to Asia, were probably damaged either by a ship's anchor or a minor earthquake, officials say. So if your online gaming experience has not been up to the mark, lagging away to world's end, then this is probably why. Initial reports suggest as much as 70 per cent of internet and telephone traffic between the continents has been affected by the outage affecting millions across the Middle East and south Asia. International telephone calls, which have also been affected, were being re-routed to work around the problem. A somewhat corny outcome of the outage is that people have been getting less spam! Inboxes which were being bombarded with hundreds of spam mail a day now get only a few.

Despite widespread wireless internet and satellite connections, and contrary to popular belief, global communications still rely largely on the vast

webs of fibre optic cables that cover the planet. The lines take years of planning to install. To repair them is even more of a challenge. As part of damage control for this recent incident, a 64-crew French maintenance boat arrived on site, off the coast of Sicily, following a two-day journey from southern France. An underwater robot was sent down to locate the cables, which may have been dragged several kilometers off site in the incident — and lift them to the surface where they will be repaired fibre by fibre.

Some trivia:

1. The crack about sharks at the beginning wasn't entirely unfounded. It seems that the very first small diameter fibre optic cables laid were indeed damaged by sharks chewing on them on the ocean floor. Scientists found that sharks were attracted by the magnetic fields formed around the cable, produced by the electrical current supplying power to the amplifiers which are placed periodically. To



Buzzword of the MONTH

Green-washing

In a world gripped by the fears of a disastrous fallout of a degenerating bio-system, Green-washing refers to the undue exploitation of environmentalism by companies. For example, if a particular product does not perform as well as its

competitors, the product is simply positioned as being eco-friendly and put on the market. Vague, untrue and irrelevant product features are highlighted as being good for the environment. This practice is known as green-washing, which is a combination of green and white-washing.